

Armies of Israel, The

The provided text discusses the **Armies of Israel**, detailing their structure, assembly, leadership, and activities.

- The Armies of Israel were assembled through various means, including **trumpet calls, special messengers, and extraordinary acts**. In some cases, the **chief scribe** was responsible for enrollment.

- The army was composed of **infantry, horsemen, and chariots** and was divided into **three divisions**, with **van and rear guards**. Companies were organized by thousands and hundreds, with captains leading each group.

- The **captain of the host** held a prominent leadership position, though the **king** often led the army personally. Inferior officers were appointed by the **shoterim** (chief officers), the king, or the captain of the host.

- **All Israelite men** from twenty years old and upward were liable to serve in the army. However, exemptions were granted for those who had built a new house, planted a vineyard, were recently betrothed or newly married. Refusal to join the army was stigmatized and often punished.

- Before going to war, the armies were **numbered and reviewed, consulted the Lord, and were encouraged** by their commanders. The Ark of the Covenant was frequently carried into battle, accompanied by priests with trumpets.

- The army's **movements were directed by God**, and their success depended on His aid. Strict discipline was maintained within the ranks, and bravery was rewarded.

- The armies were provisioned through various means, including food brought by soldiers, sent by their families, levied contributions, and presents.

- Upon returning from victorious battles, the armies were congratulated and purified.

After the war, they were disbanded, though some were retained by the kings during peacetime.

Overall, the text presents a comprehensive picture of the Armies of Israel, highlighting their organization, leadership, religious practices, and the importance of divine guidance in their military endeavors.

Armies of Israel, The

First mention of.

Exodus 7:4 But Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you, that I may lay my hand upon Egypt, and bring forth mine armies, and my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great judgments.

COLLECTED BY

Sound of trumpets.

Judges 3:27 And it came to pass, when he was come, that he blew a trumpet in the mountain of Ephraim, and the children of Israel went down with him from the mount, and he before them.

Judges 6:34 But the Spirit of the LORD came upon Gideon, and he blew a trumpet; and Abiezer was gathered after him.

Special messengers.

Judges 6:35 And he sent messengers throughout all Manasseh; who also was gathered after him: and he sent messengers unto Asher, and unto Zebulun, and unto Naphtali; and they came up to meet them.

2 Samuel 20:14 And he went through all the Tribes of Israel unto Abel, and to Bethmaachah, and all the Berites: and they were gathered together, and went also after him.

Extraordinary means.

Judges 19:29 And when he was come into his house, he took a knife, and laid hold on his concubine, and divided her, together with her bones, into twelve pieces, and sent her into all the coasts of Israel.

Judges 20:1 Then all the children of Israel went out, and the Congregation was gathered together as one man, from Dan even to Beersheba, with the land of Gilead, unto the LORD in Mizpeh.

1 Samuel 11:7 And he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them throughout all the coasts of Israel by the hands of messengers, saying, Whosoever cometh not forth after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done unto his oxen. And the fear of the LORD fell on the people, and they came out with one consent.

Enrolled by the chief scribe.

2 Kings 25:19 And out of the city he took an officer that was set over the men of war, and five men of them that were in the king's presence, which were found in the city, and the principal scribe of

the host, which mustered the people of the land, and threescore men of the people of the land that were found in the city:

CALLED

The host.

Deuteronomy 23:9 When the host goeth forth against thine enemies, then keep thee from every wicked thing.

1 Samuel 28:19 Moreover the LORD will also deliver Israel with thee into the hand of the Philistines: and to morrow shalt thou and thy sons be with me: the LORD also shall deliver the host of Israel into the hand of the Philistines.

The armies of the living God.

1 Samuel 17:26 And David spake to the men that stood by him, saying, What shall be done to the man that killeth this Philistine, and taketh away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?

Composed of infantry.

Numbers 11:21 And Moses said, The people, among whom I am, are six hundred thousand footmen; and thou hast said, I will give them flesh, that they may eat a whole month.

Judges 5:15 And the Princes of Issachar were with Deborah; even Issachar, and also Barak: he was sent on foot into the valley. For the divisions of Reuben there were great thoughts of heart.

Horsemen and chariots introduced into, after David's reign.

1 Kings 1:5 Then Adonijah the son of Haggith exalted himself, saying, I will be king: and he prepared him chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him.

1 Kings 4:26 And Solomon had forty thousand stalls of Horses for his chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen.

DIVIDED INTO

Three divisions.

Judges 7:16 And he divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put a trumpet in every man's hand, with empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers.

1 Samuel 11:11 And it was so on the morrow, that Saul put the people in three companies; and they came into the midst of the host in the morning watch, and slew the Ammonites until the heat of the day: and it came to pass, that they which remained were scattered, so that two of them were not left together.

Van and rear.

Joshua 6:9 And the armed men went before the priests that blew with the trumpets, and the rereward came after the ark, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets.

Companies of thousands, ect.

Numbers 31:14 And Moses was wroth with the officers of the host, with the Captains over thousands, and Captains over hundreds, which came from the battle.

2 Kings 1:9 Then the king sent unto him a captain of fifty with his fifty. And he went up to him: and, behold, he sat on the top of an hill. And he spake unto him, Thou man of God, the king hath said, Come down.

2 Kings 1:11 Again also he sent unto him another captain of fifty with his fifty. And he answered and said unto him, O man of God, thus hath the king said, Come down quickly.

1 Chronicles 13:1 And David consulted with the Captains of thousands and hundreds, and with every leader.

1 Chronicles 27:1 Now the children of Israel after their number, to wit, the chief Fathers and Captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers that served the king in any matter of the courses, which came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, of every course were twenty and four thousand.

Commanded by the captain of the host.

2 Samuel 2:8 But Abner the son of Ner, captain of Saul's host, took Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and brought him over to Mahanaim;

2 Samuel 17:25 And Absalom made Amasa captain of the host instead of Joab: which Amasa was a man's son, whose name was Ithra an Israelite, that went in to Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruiah Joab's mother.

2 Samuel 20:23 Now Joab was over all the host of Israel: and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites:

Often led by the king in person.

1 Samuel 8:20 That we also may be like all the nations; and that our king may Judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles.

1 Samuel 15:4-5 And Saul gathered the people together, and numbered them in Telaim, two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand men of Judah. 5 And Saul came to a city of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley.

2 Samuel 12:29 And David gathered all the people together, and went to Rabbah, and fought against it, and took it.

1 Kings 22 And they continued three years without war between Syria and Israel. 2 And it came to pass in the third year, that Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel. 3 And the king of Israel said unto his servants, Know ye that Ramoth in Gilead is ours, and we be still, and take it not out of the hand of the king of Syria? 4 And he said unto Jehoshaphat, Wilt thou go with me to battle to Ramothgilead? And Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, I am as thou Art, my people as thy people, my Horses as thy Horses. ...

INFERIOR OFFICERS OF, APPOINTED BY

The shoterim or chief officers.

Deuteronomy 20:9 And it shall be, when the officers have made an end of speaking unto the people, that they shall make Captains of the armies to lead the people.

The king.

2 Samuel 18:1 And David numbered the people that were with him, and set Captains of thousands and Captains of hundreds over them.

2 Chronicles 25:5 Moreover Amaziah gathered Judah together, and made them Captains over thousands, and Captains over hundreds, according to the houses of their Fathers, throughout all Judah and Benjamin: and he numbered them from twenty years old and above, and found them three hundred thousand choice men, able to go forth to war, that could handle spear and shield.

The captain of the host.

2 Samuel 18:11 And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest him, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten shekels of silver, and a girdle.

2 Kings 4:13 And he said unto him, Say now unto her, Behold, thou hast been Careful for us with all this care; what is to be done for thee? wouldest thou be spoken for to the king, or to the captain of the host? And she answered, I dwell among mine own people.

Persons liable to serve in.

Numbers 1:2-3 Take ye the sum of all the Congregation of the children of Israel, after their families, by the house of their Fathers, with the number of their names, every male by their polls; 3 From twenty years old and upward, all that are able to go forth to war in Israel: thou and Aaron shall number them by their armies.

PERSONS EXEMPTED FROM SERVING IN

Who had builded a house.

Deuteronomy 20:5 And the officers shall speak unto the people, saying, What man is there that hath built a new house, and hath not dedicated it? let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man dedicate it.

Who had planted a vineyard.

Deuteronomy 20:6 And what man is he that hath planted a vineyard, and hath not yet eaten of it? let him also go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man eat of it.

Who were lately betrothed.

Deuteronomy 20:7 And what man is there that hath betrothed a wife, and hath not taken her? let him go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man take her.

Who were newly married.

Deuteronomy 24:5 When a man hath taken a new wife, he shall not go out to war, neither shall he be charged with any business: but he shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer up his wife which he hath taken.

Refusing to join, stigmatized.

Judges 5:15-17 And the Princes of Issachar were with Deborah; even Issachar, and also Barak: he was sent on foot into the valley. For the divisions of Reuben there were great thoughts of heart. 16 Why abodest thou among the sheepfolds, to hear the bleatings of the flocks? For the divisions of Reuben there were great searchings of heart. 17 Gilead Abode beyond Jordan: and why did Dan remain in ships? Asher continued on the sea shore, and Abode in his breaches.

Refusing to join, often Punished.

Judges 21:5 And the children of Israel said, Who is there among all the Tribes of Israel that came not up with the Congregation unto the LORD? For they had made a great Oath concerning him that came not up to the LORD to Mizpeh, saying, He shall surely be put to Death.

Judges 21:8-11 And they said, What one is there of the Tribes of Israel that came not up to Mizpeh to the LORD? And, behold, there came none to the camp from Jabeshgilead to the assembly. 9 For the people were numbered, and, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead there. 10 And the Congregation sent thither twelve thousand men of the valiantest, and commanded them, saying, Go and smite the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead with the edge of the sword, with the Women and the children. 11 And this is the thing that ye shall do, Ye shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman that hath lain by man.

1 Samuel 11:7 And he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them

throughout all the coasts of Israel by the hands of messengers, saying, Whosoever cometh not forth after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done unto his oxen. And the fear of the LORD fell on the people, and they came out with one consent.

The fearful allowed to leave.

Deuteronomy 20:8 And the officers shall speak further unto the people, and they shall say, What man is there that is fearful and fainthearted? let him go and return unto his house, lest his Brethren's heart faint as well as his heart.

Judges 7:3 Now therefore go to, proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, Whosoever is fearful and afraid, let him return and depart early from mount Gilead. And there returned of the people twenty and two thousand; and there remained ten thousand.

Sometimes consisted of the whole nation.

Judges 20:11 So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, knit together as one man.

1 Samuel 11:7 And he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them throughout all the coasts of Israel by the hands of messengers, saying, Whosoever cometh not forth after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done unto his oxen. And the fear of the LORD fell on the people, and they came out with one consent.

Strict discipline observed in.

Joshua 7:16-21 So Joshua rose up early in the morning, and brought Israel by their tribes; and the tribe of Judah was taken: 17 And he brought the family of Judah; and he took the family of the Zarhites: and he brought the family of the Zarhites man by man; and Zabdi was taken: 18 And he brought his household man by man; and Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was taken. 19 And Joshua said unto Achan, My son, give, I pray thee, glory to the LORD God of Israel, and make Confession unto him; and tell me now what thou hast done; hide it not from me. ...

1 Samuel 14:24-44 And the men of Israel were distressed that day: for Saul had adjured the people, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food until evening, that I may be avenged

on mine enemies. So none of the people tasted any food. 25 And all they of the land came to a wood; and there was honey upon the ground. 26 And when the people were come into the wood, behold, the honey dropped; but no man put his hand to his mouth: for the people feared the Oath. 27 But Jonathan heard not when his Father charged the people with the Oath: wherefore he put forth the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in an honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes were enlightened. ...

Educated in the Art of war.

Isaiah 2:4 And he shall Judge among the nations, and shall rebuke many people: and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.

Micah 4:3 And he shall Judge among many people, and rebuke strong nations afar off; and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.

Often supplied with arms from public armories.

2 Chronicles 11:12 And in every several city he put shields and spears, and made them exceeding strong, having Judah and Benjamin on his side.

2 Chronicles 26:14 And Uzziah prepared for them throughout all the host shields, and spears, and helmets, and habergeons, and bows, and slings to cast stones.

BEFORE GOING TO WAR

Were numbered and reviewed.

2 Samuel 18:1-2 And David numbered the people that were with him, and set Captains of thousands and Captains of hundreds over them. 2 And David sent forth a third part of the people under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. And the king said unto the people, I will surely go forth with you myself also.

2 Samuel 18:4 And the king said unto them, What seemeth you best I will do. And the king

stood by the gate side, and all the people came out by hundreds and by thousands.

1 Kings 10:15 Beside that he had of the merchantmen, and of the traffick of the spice merchants, and of all the kings of Arabia, and of the Governors of the country.

1 Kings 10:27 And the king made silver to be in Jerusalem as stones, and cedars made he to be as the sycomore trees that are in the vale, for Abundance.

Required to keep from iniquity.

Deuteronomy 23:9 When the host goeth forth against thine enemies, then keep thee from every wicked thing.

Consulted the Lord.

Judges 1:1 Now after the Death of Joshua it came to pass, that the children of Israel asked the LORD, saying, Who shall go up for us against the Canaanites first, to fight against them?

Judges 20:27-28 And the children of Israel inquired of the LORD, (for the Ark of the Covenant of God was there in those days, 28 And Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days,) saying, Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And the LORD said, Go up; for to morrow I will deliver them into thine hand.

Encouraged by their commanders.

2 Chronicles 20:20 And they rose early in the morning, and went forth into the wilderness of Tekoa: and as they went forth, Jehoshaphat stood and said, Hear me, O Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem; Believe in the LORD your God, so shall ye be established; believe his Prophets, so shall ye prosper.

Ark of God frequently brought with.

Joshua 6:6-7 And Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said unto them, Take up the Ark of the Covenant, and let seven priests bear Seven Trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD. 7 And he said unto the people, Pass on, and Compass the city, and let him that is armed pass on before the ark of the LORD.

1 Samuel 4:4-5 So the people sent to Shiloh, that they might bring from thence the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth between the Cherubims: and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the Ark of the Covenant of God. 5 And when the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD came into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth rang again.

2 Samuel 11:11 And Uriah said unto David, The ark, and Israel, and Judah, abide in tents; and my lord Joab, and the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open fields; shall I then go into mine house, to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? as thou livest, and as thy soul liveth, I will not do this thing.

2 Samuel 15:24 And lo Zadok also, and all the Levites were with him, bearing the Ark of the Covenant of God: and they set down the ark of God; and Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city.

Attended by priest with trumpets.

Numbers 10:9 And if ye go to war in your land against the enemy that oppresseth you, then ye shall blow an alarm with the trumpets; and ye shall be remembered before the LORD your God, and ye shall be saved from your enemies.

Numbers 31:6 And Moses sent them to the war, a thousand of every tribe, them and Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the holy instruments, and the trumpets to blow in his hand.

2 Chronicles 13:13-14 But Jeroboam caused an Ambushment to come about behind them: so they were before Judah, and the Ambushment was behind them. 14 And when Judah looked back, behold, the battle was before and behind: and they cried unto the LORD, and the priests sounded with the trumpets.

Praises of God often sung before.

2 Chronicles 20:21-22 And when he had consulted with the people, he appointed singers unto the LORD, and that should praise the beauty of holiness, as they went out before the army, and

to say, Praise the LORD; for his mercy endureth for ever. 22 And when they began to Sing and to praise, the LORD set ambushments against the children of Ammon, Moab, and mount Seir, which were come against Judah; and they were smitten.

Often disposed to battle with Judgment, ect.

2 Samuel 10:9 When Joab saw that the front of the battle was against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in Array against the Syrians:

Bravery and fidelity in, rewarded.

Joshua 15:16 And Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjathsepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.

1 Samuel 17:25 And the men of Israel said, Have ye seen this man that is come up? surely to defy Israel is he come up: and it shall be, that the man who killeth him, the king will enrich him with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and make his Father's house free in Israel.

1 Samuel 18:17 And Saul said to David, Behold my elder daughter Merab, her will I give thee to wife: only be thou valiant for me, and fight the LORDS' battles. For Saul said, Let not mine hand be upon him, but let the hand of the Philistines be upon him.

2 Samuel 18:11 And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest him, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten shekels of silver, and a girdle.

1 Chronicles 11:6 And David said, Whosoever smiteth the Jebusites first shall be chief and captain. So Joab the son of Zeruiah went first up, and was chief.

Men selected from, for difficult enterprises.

Exodus 17:9 And Moses said unto Joshua, Choose us out men, and go out, fight with Amalek: to morrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in mine hand.

Numbers 31:5-6 So there were delivered out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand of every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war. 6 And Moses sent them to the war, a thousand of every tribe, them and Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the holy instruments,

and the trumpets to blow in his hand.

Directed in their movements by God.

Joshua 8:1-2 And the LORD said unto Joshua, Fear not, neither be thou dismayed: take all the people of war with thee, and arise, go up to Ai: see, I have given into thy hand the king of Ai, and his people, and his city, and his land: 2 And thou shalt do to Ai and her king as thou didst unto Jericho and her king: only the spoil thereof, and the cattle thereof, shall ye take for a prey unto yourselves: lay thee an ambush for the city behind it.

With the aid of God all-powerful.

Leviticus 26:3 If ye walk in my statutes, and keep my commandments, and do them;

Leviticus 26:7-8 And ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword. 8 And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.

Without God easily overcome.

Leviticus 26:17 And I will set my face against you, and ye shall be slain before your enemies: they that hate you shall reign over you; and ye shall flee when none pursueth you.

Numbers 14:42 Go not up, for the LORD is not among you; that ye be not smitten before your enemies.

Numbers 14:45 Then the Amalekites came down, and the Canaanites which dwelt in that hill, and smote them, and Discomfited them, even unto Hormah.

MODE OF PROVISIONING:

Food brought by themselves.

Joshua 1:11 Pass through the host, and command the people, saying, Prepare you victuals; for within three days ye shall pass over this Jordan, to go in to possess the land, which the LORD your God giveth you to possess it.

Food sent by their families.

1 Samuel 17:17 And Jesse said unto David his son, Take now for thy Brethren an ephah of this

parched Corn, and these ten loaves, and run to the camp to thy Brethren;

Contribution levied.

Judges 8:5 And he said unto the men of Succoth, Give, I pray you, loaves of bread unto the people that follow me; for they be faint, and I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, kings of Midian.

1 Samuel 25:4-8 And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal did shear his sheep. 5 And David sent out ten young men, and David said unto the young men, Get you up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and greet him in my name: 6 And thus shall ye say to him that liveth in prosperity, Peace be both to thee, and peace be to thine house, and peace be unto all that thou hast. 7 And now I have heard that thou hast shearers: now thy shepherds which were with us, we hurt them not, neither was there ought missing unto them, all the while they were in Carmel. ...

By presents.

2 Samuel 17:27-29 And it came to pass, when David was come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim, 28 Brought beds, and basons, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and flour, and parched Corn, and beans, and lentiles, and parched pulse, 29 And honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese of kine, for David, and for the people that were with him, to eat: for they said, The people is hungry, and weary, and thirsty, in the wilderness. Congratulated on returning victorious.

1 Samuel 18:6-7 And it came to pass as they came, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, that the Women came out of all cities of Israel, Singing and dancing, to meet king Saul, with tabrets, with joy, and with instruments of musick. 7 And the Women answered one another as they played, and said, Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.

Purified on returning from war.

Numbers 31:19-24 And do ye abide without the camp seven days: whosoever hath killed any

person, and whosoever hath touched any slain, purify both yourselves and your captives on the third day, and on the Seventh Day. 20 And purify all your raiment, and all that is made of skins, and all work of goats' hair, and all things made of wood. 21 And Eleazar the priest said unto the men of war which went to the battle, This is the ordinance of The Law which the LORD commanded Moses; 22 Only the gold, and the silver, the brass, the iron, the tin, and the lead, ...

Disbanded after war.

1 Samuel 13:2 Saul chose him three thousand men of Israel; whereof two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in mount Bethel, and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin: and the rest of the people he sent every man to his tent.

1 Kings 22:36 And there went a proclamation throughout the host about the going down of the sun, saying, Every man to his city, and every man to his own country.

Part of, retained in times of peace by the kings.

1 Samuel 13:1-2 Saul reigned one year; and when he had reigned two years over Israel, 2 Saul chose him three thousand men of Israel; whereof two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in mount Bethel, and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin: and the rest of the people he sent every man to his tent.

1 Chronicles 27:1-15 Now the children of Israel after their number, to wit, the chief Fathers and Captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers that served the king in any matter of the courses, which came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, of every course were twenty and four thousand. 2 Over the first course for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel: and in his course were twenty and four thousand. 3 Of the children of Perez was the chief of all the Captains of the host for the first month. 4 And over the course of the second month was Dodai an Ahohite, and of his course was Mikloth also the ruler: in his course likewise were twenty and four thousand. ...